

SAMRA IFTIKHAR, M.B.B.S, FCPS

Diagnostic Radiologist | Postdoctoral Fellow Researcher

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PMDC Registration: 23182-N | CPSP Fellow Registration: RAD-23-34350

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Academic researcher with 2 years of experience at Yale School of Medicine, focused on advanced neuroimaging (resting-state fMRI, graph theory). FCPS-trained Diagnostic Radiologist with 4 years of postgraduate radiology training and 2.5+ years of emergency radiology experience in high-volume hospital settings. Experienced in cross-sectional imaging (CT/MRI), radiography, and sonography (OB/GYN, trauma, Doppler), with interventional procedure experience including biopsies and drainage.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Research & Academia: Resting-state fMRI, functional connectivity, graph theory, manuscript writing, literature reviews, systematic reviews, data extraction, IRB participation, peer review
- Systems & Tools: PACS, Visage, DICOM (RadiAnt), Epic, SPSS, EndNote, MATLAB, FSL, CONN, GIFT neuroimaging toolbox, BrainNet, Microsoft Office, Google Workspace
- Clinical Radiology: CT, MRI, X-ray, Sonography (OB/GYN, Doppler), emergency, and trauma imaging, second reads/consultations
- Procedures: Core breast biopsy, ultrasound-guided biopsies and placement of wires and targets in breast lesions, thyroid FNAC, fluoroscopy (HSG, barium studies, MCUG)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Postdoctoral Fellow, Clinical Neuroplasticity Lab (CNL) | Radiology & Biomedical

Imaging, Yale School of Medicine

New Haven, CT | May 2025 – Present

- “Dynamic Functional Connectivity with Hemispheric Reorganization in Left Frontal and Temporal Lobe Tumors.” under revisions for Cerebral Cortex.
- Co-authored manuscript: “Functional Network Correlates of Aphasia and Compensation in Brain Tumor Patients: A Graph Theoretical Analysis of Resting-State fMRI.”
- Contributing author, book chapter on the utility of fMRI and DTI, in *Hybrid PET/MR Neuroimaging: A Comprehensive Approach*.
- Editorial on “PET Imaging in Neurological Disorders: From Established Clinical Applications to Theranostics, AI, and Metabolic Connectivity”.

- Peer reviewer for *Cureus* (reviewed 20) and *Clinical Radiology* (reviewed 3).

Lab Associate, The Tu Lab for Diagnostic Radiology (TLDR) | Radiology & Biomedical Imaging, Yale School of Medicine
New Haven, CT | May 2024 – April 2025

- Co-authored peer-reviewed publications and abstracts spanning neuroradiology, oncologic imaging, and radiology workflow quality improvement.
- Contributed to case reports, posters, and educational exhibits presented at international meetings as a senior author (e.g., RSNA, Korean Congress of Radiology).

Training Registrar, Emergency Radiology | Khyber Teaching Hospital
Peshawar, Pakistan | December 2021 – November 2024

- Interpreted 20–30 radiologic studies daily, including trauma CT, MRI, and radiography, supporting emergency and inpatient services.
- Performed 100+ ultrasound examinations daily (OB/GYN, trauma, Doppler), including urgent bedside assessments.
- Performed core breast biopsies and wire localizations for mammographic lesion evaluation.
- Provided real-time consultation on imaging selection and interpretation for ED and inpatient teams.

Specialist Registrar, Radiology | Northwest General Hospital & Research Center
Peshawar, Pakistan | September 2021 – November 2021

- Performed urgent bedside Doppler ultrasound for ICU and neurosurgery patients.
- Diagnosed acute radiologic emergencies via POCUS with rapid communication to clinical teams.

Postgraduate Resident, FCPS Diagnostic Radiology | Northwest General Hospital & Research Center
Peshawar, Pakistan | July 2017 – June 2021

- Completed 4-year diagnostic radiology training, having passed the exit/Fellowship exam.
- Reported CT/MRI across neuroradiology, abdominal imaging, MSK, and genitourinary domains.
- Performed fluoroscopy (HSG, barium studies, MCUG) and image-guided procedures (biopsies, thyroid FNAC).
- Led journal clubs, case discussions, CME workshops, multidisciplinary and peer teaching sessions

House Officer (Internship) | Kuwait Teaching Hospital
Peshawar, Pakistan | July 2016 – June 2017

- Completed clinical rotations in medicine, cardiology, ICU, ophthalmology, and general surgery.
- Assisted in diagnosis, emergency care, and surgical management for inpatients and outpatients.

EDUCATION & TRAINING

FCPS (Diagnostic Radiology) — Fellow of College of Physicians and Surgeons Pakistan (CPSP), 2021–present

M.B.B.S. — Peshawar Medical College, 2010–2015

LICENSURE, CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

- Pakistan Medical and Dental Council (PMDC) Registration: 23182-N
- CPSP Fellow Registration: RAD-23-34350
- Peer Reviewer: *Cureus, Clinical Radiology*
- Member: American Roentgen Ray Society (2026–2027)
- Member: American Society of Functional Neuroradiology (2024–2025)
- Member: Radiology Society of Pakistan (2017–2020)

RESEARCH & SCHOLARSHIP

Peer-Reviewed Publications

1. **Iftikhar S**, Rahmani S, Zaree OA, Kertam A, Farquhar T, Tu LH. The value of radiology consultation: effort allocation, clinical impact, and untapped opportunities. *J Am Coll Radiol.* 2025;22(8):887–896. doi:10.1016/j.jacr.2025.04.006.
2. Bahrami A, Tu LH, Ghanikolahloo M, et al., **Iftikhar S**. Disparities in MRI and TRUS for prostate cancer detection: a systematic review and meta-analysis of 94,020 cases. *Curr Probl Diagn Radiol.* 2025 ;Aug 8.
3. Khan M, Ahmad M, Qudrat S, Tu L, Khan S, Yetiskul E, **Iftikhar S**. Failure of the tyrosine kinase inhibitors osimertinib and erlotinib to manage a patient with EGFR-mutant lung adenocarcinoma: a case report. *AME Case Rep.* 2025;9. doi:10.21037/acr-24-122.
4. **Iftikhar S**, Ijaz N, Iftikhar S, Khan S. Intramedullary spinal tuberculoma: an uncommon presentation of a common disorder. *Cureus.* 2022;14(9):e28761. doi:10.7759/cureus.28761.
5. **Iftikhar S**, Iftikhar S, Ijaz N, Akhtar M, Gul H. A rare facultative anaerobe causing emphysematous osteomyelitis of the pubic bone. *Cureus.* 2022;14(7):e26575. doi:10.7759/cureus.26575.

6. Khan W, Nawaz K, **Iftikhar S**. Pulsus parvus et tardus in bilateral renal arteries on flow Doppler leading to the diagnosis of coarctation of the aorta. *Pakistan Journal of Radiology*. 2022;32(A-42):P-104.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Oral Presentations

- **Iftikhar S**, Rahmani S, Aali A, Napolitano A, Moliterno J, Constable T, Pasquini L. Dynamic functional connectivity with inter-hemispheric organization in left frontal and temporal tumors. ARRS 2026 Annual Meeting, April 12–15, 2026, Pittsburgh, PA.

Poster Presentations & Educational Exhibits

- **Iftikhar S**, Rahmani S, Aali A, Napolitano A, Moliterno J, Constable T, Pasquini L. Dynamic functional connectivity with hemispheric organization in left frontal and temporal tumors. ASNR 2026 Annual Meeting, May 17–20, 2026, Austin, TX
- Rahmani S, **Iftikhar S**, Aali A, et al. Non-Contrast Resting-State fMRI for Mapping Language Dysfunction and Compensation in Brain Tumor Patients. Oral presentation: RSNA 2025 Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL, Nov 30–Dec 4, 2025.
- Kuehne A, Chen D, Merriam C, et al., **Iftikhar S**. A Large Cement Embolism After Kyphoplasty: Detectable even on Portable Radiograph. Poster: ENRS Annual Meeting, Washington, DC, Aug 8–11, 2024.
- Kuehne A, Chen D, Merriam C, et al., **Iftikhar S**. Diplopia Related to Internuclear Ophthalmoplegia Explained by a Punctate Ischemic Infarct of the Medial Longitudinal Fasciculus. Poster: ENRS Annual Meeting, Washington, DC, Aug 8–11, 2024.
- Gathagan RJ, Kuehne A, Chen D, et al., **Iftikhar S**. Hiding in Plain Sight: Predominantly Fluid Intracranial Dermoid Masquerading as an Arachnoid Cyst. Presentation: ASER Annual Meeting, Washington, DC, 2024.
- Sison J, **Iftikhar S**, Tu LH. Think Twice: A review of report discrepancy rates in second interpretations. Poster: KCR Annual Meeting, Seoul, South Korea, Oct 2–5, 2024.
- Sison J, **Iftikhar S**, Tegtmeyer K, Tu LH. Standardized reporting in the emergency department. Poster: KCR Annual Meeting, Seoul, South Korea, Oct 2–5, 2024.

- Santo IDO, Adin M, Bronen R, et al., **Iftikhar S.** Pearls and pitfalls of easy-to-miss epileptogenic etiologies. Educational exhibit: RSNA 2024 Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL, Dec 1–5, 2024.
- Kuehne A, Chen D, Wu K, et al., **Iftikhar S.** Private foundations: logistics, benefits, and pitfalls. Educational exhibit: RSNA 2024 Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL, 2024.
- Kuehne A, Chen D, Gathagan R, et al., **Iftikhar S.** Private foundations vs. public charities: guide for the radiologist. Educational exhibit: RSNA 2024 Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL, 2024.

Postgraduate Dissertation/Thesis

- “Predicting the success rate of extra shockwave lithotripsy using computed tomography: A cross-sectional study in a tertiary care hospital” (Dec 2020 – Jun 2021).

Manuscripts & Projects (In Progress)

- Book chapter (contributing author): “Hybrid PET/MR Neuroimaging: A Comprehensive Approach” .
- Clinical application of metabolic connectivity in neurological disorders: A systematic review.
- DMN and CEN anticorrelation in aphasic vs Non-aphasic patients with brain tumor.
- Editorial on PET imaging in Neurological disorders.

TEACHING & MENTORSHIP

Radiology Educator & Intern Supervisor

Northwest General Hospital & Research Center | July 2017 – June 2021,

Khyber Teaching Hospital, Peshawar, Pakistan | November 2021 – April 2024,

Yale Integrated Neuroscience Program, January 2026 - February 2026.

- Taught clinical radiology to Bachelor of Radiographic Sciences students (7th semester), designed assessments and conducted examinations.
- Supervised 10–15 interns in daily scan review, emergency case triage, and reporting protocols.
- Delivered lectures and workshops on scan interpretation and radiology workflow.
- Taught clinical fMRI minicourse for INP (Integrated Neuroscience Program) at Yale Department of Neurosciences.

LEADERSHIP & SERVICE

- Chief Resident, Radiology Department, Northwest General Hospital & Research Center (2018–2021).
- Training Registrar supervision: managed schedules and oversaw 10–15 radiology interns across imaging stations, including emergency ultrasound coverage.
- Undergraduate Medical Research Conference (Peshawar Medical College): Head of Plenary Sessions (2014), Scientific Committee Member (2010–2014), Editorial Member (2010).
- IRB participation: lab representative for IRB review committees (Yale-2025).

CONTINUING EDUCATION

- American Roentgen Ray Society (ARRS) (2026)
- Royal College of Radiologists Conference, Birmingham, United Kingdom (2023).
- Imaging in Small Vessel Disease: Current Concepts and Future Developments (RCR) (2021).
- Imaging Interstitial Lung Disease in Children – New Approach and Recommendations (RCR) (2020).
- Radiopaedia Virtual Radiology Conference (2019, 2020).
- Global Webinar Series: Pediatric Cardiac Imaging for Everyone (RCR) (2020).
- Diagnostic Medicine: From Stethoscope to Artificial Intelligence (RCPE) (2019).
- Diabetes and Endocrinology Symposium (RCPE) (2019).

VOLUNTEER & COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

- Breast cancer awareness program for Northwest General Hospital and Research Center, Peshawar.(October- 2021).
- Arranged CME radiology conference, Northwest General Hospital and Research Center, Peshawar(Oct 2019).
- Free ultrasound medical camp, Northwest General Hospital and Research Center , Peshawar (Aug 2018).
- Campus newspaper article: “New directions in undergraduate medical research” (Mar 2011).

Languages: English, Urdu, Pashto.

REFERENCES

- Dr. Luca Pasquini, MD, PhD — Assistant Professor of Radiology & Biomedical Imaging, Yale School of Medicine — Luca.Pasquini@yale.edu
- Dr. Long H. Tu, MD, PhD — Assistant Professor of Radiology & Biomedical Imaging, Yale School of Medicine — Long.tu@yale.edu
- Dr. Shandana Khan, MBBS, FCPS — Assistant Professor & Head of Radiology, Northwest General Hospital & Research Center — Skshandana@gmail.com